

Community Partnerships Reference Guide

Building and Sustaining Relationships That Expand Impact

WHY PARTNERSHIPS MATTER

No single organization can meet the full range of needs a community presents. Partnerships extend AJFC's reach, reduce duplication of services, and open doors for the clients you serve. The relationships you build are part of the resource you bring to this work.

TYPES OF PARTNERS

Employers	Provide job opportunities, internships, and on-the-job training for clients.
Government Agencies	Align services with public programs and funding streams.
Educational Institutions	Connect clients to training, certifications, and academic programs.
Nonprofits & CBOs	Address complementary needs such as housing, food, and mental health.
Faith Communities	Provide community trust, volunteers, and flexible support resources.
Healthcare Providers	Address health-related barriers that affect client stability and progress.

WHAT MAKES A PARTNERSHIP WORK

- Define what each party brings and what each party needs before formalizing.
- Put agreements in writing. An MOU protects both organizations and sets expectations.
- Communicate regularly, not only when something goes wrong.
- Track referrals and outcomes so you can show the partnership is working.
- Revisit the agreement annually and update it as needs change.

MOU ESSENTIALS

Purpose	Why the partnership exists and what problem it addresses.
Roles	What each organization is responsible for delivering.
Referral Process	How clients will be connected between organizations.
Data Sharing	What information is shared, how, and within what privacy limits.
Duration & Review	How long the MOU is in effect and when it will be reviewed.

MEASURING PARTNERSHIP VALUE

- Number of referrals made and received.
- Percentage of referrals that resulted in a completed service.
- Resources or funding unlocked through the partnership.
- Client outcomes attributable to the combined effort.

"If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together." ~ African Proverb